

Jeremiah 25 - 27

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Messianic Connections (WEB)

Tonight the book widens. For twenty-four chapters Jeremiah has been speaking to Judah. Here he is handed a cup and told to carry it to the nations.

Twenty-three years of preaching, summarized in one sentence: but you have not listened.

Seventy years put on a calendar - the first time the exile is given an end date.

A prophet walking through Jerusalem with a wooden yoke strapped to his own neck.

A trial in the temple court where the charge is a sermon and the penalty is death.

Jeremiah 25 turns a local judgment into a global one, and puts the cup of wrath in the hand of every kingdom on the earth - beginning, uncomfortably, with the city that bears Yahweh's name.

Jeremiah 26 puts the prophet on trial for the temple sermon, and is saved by the memory of an old prophecy and the courage of one official who refused to hand him over.

Jeremiah 27 asks Judah to do the humiliating thing: put your neck under the yoke and live - and warns that the voices promising a quick end to it were never sent.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 25 - Twenty-Three Years, Seventy Years, and the Cup No Nation Refuses

Key Notes

- The chapter is dated to Jehoiakim's fourth year - the same year Nebuchadnezzar took the throne. Two clocks start together, and one of them is running out (Jeremiah 25:1-2).
- Jeremiah counts his own ministry: twenty-three years of speaking, "rising up early and speaking; but you have not listened." The idiom pictures a man who gets up before dawn to try again (Jeremiah 25:3).
- He was not alone. Yahweh sent "all his servants the prophets," and the response to every one of them was the same silence (Jeremiah 25:4).
- The message they all carried was startlingly modest: turn from evil, don't chase other gods, and you may stay in the land. The offer was never complicated (Jeremiah 25:5-6).
- Nebuchadnezzar is called "my servant" - a pagan emperor given the same title as Moses and David, because sovereignty is not limited to those who acknowledge it (Jeremiah 25:9).
- The judgment is described by what will go missing: mirth, gladness, bridegroom, bride, the sound of millstones, the light of a lamp. Ordinary domestic noise, and then nothing (Jeremiah 25:10).
- Then comes the number that changes everything. Seventy years - the first time this catastrophe is given a boundary. Exile is announced with an expiry date attached (Jeremiah 25:11).
- And Babylon is not exempt. When the seventy years are done, the instrument of judgment is judged in turn, for exactly the same reason: iniquity (Jeremiah 25:12-14).
- Jeremiah is handed the cup of the wine of wrath and told to make the nations drink. The vision moves from Jerusalem outward through Egypt, Philistia, Edom, Moab, Ammon, Tyre, Arabia, Elam, Media, and finally Sheshach - a cipher for Babylon itself (Jeremiah 25:15-26).
- The most sobering line in the chapter is the order of service: "I begin to work evil at the city which is called by my name." Judgment starts at the household of God (Jeremiah 25:29).
- The imagery turns cosmic - Yahweh roaring from His holy habitation, treading grapes, entering into judgment with all flesh, a great storm rising from the ends of the earth (Jeremiah 25:30-33).
- The chapter closes on the shepherds again: wail, wallow in dust, no way to flee, no escape - the leaders who lost the flock are the last ones offered cover (Jeremiah 25:34-38).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Rising Up Early and Sending Prophets	Jeremiah 25:3-4 • Jeremiah 7:25 • 2 Chronicles 36:15-16
A Simple Offer Repeatedly Refused	Jeremiah 25:5 • Jeremiah 18:11 • Ezekiel 33:11
A Pagan King Called "My Servant"	Jeremiah 25:9 • Isaiah 10:5 • Isaiah 45:1

Topic	References
The Ordinary Sounds That Stop	Jeremiah 25:10 • Jeremiah 7:34 • Jeremiah 16:9
Seventy Years Counted	Jeremiah 25:11-12 • 2 Chronicles 36:21 • Daniel 9:2
The Cup of Wrath in Yahweh's Hand	Jeremiah 25:15 • Psalm 75:8 • Isaiah 51:17
Judgment Beginning at His Own House	Jeremiah 25:29 • 1 Peter 4:17 • Ezekiel 9:6
Yahweh Roaring From Zion	Jeremiah 25:30 • Amos 1:2 • Joel 3:16

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
All Authority Held on Loan	Jeremiah 25:9 • Romans 13:1 • John 19:11
The Bridegroom's Voice Silenced and Restored	Jeremiah 25:10 • Revelation 18:22-23 • John 3:29
The Cup He Asked to Pass, and Drank	Jeremiah 25:15 • Matthew 26:39 • John 18:11
The Winepress Trodden Alone	Jeremiah 25:30 • Revelation 14:19-20 • Isaiah 63:3
A Controversy With All the Nations	Jeremiah 25:31 • Joel 3:2 • Matthew 25:31-32
The Shepherds Who Could Not Flee	Jeremiah 25:34-35 • John 10:12-13 • Ezekiel 34:10

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 25 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the seventy-year prophecy and the cup of wrath carried to the nations
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 25](#) - the seventy years read alongside the Sabbath-year statutes of Leviticus 26
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 25](#) - exposition of Nebuchadnezzar as Yahweh's servant and the sequence of nations in the cup vision

Jeremiah 25 - Opening Intro

Twenty-three years. That is what verse 3 puts on the table before anything else happens - not a doctrine, an accounting. Jeremiah has been preaching since the thirteenth year of Josiah, through a reformation and a relapse and three kings, and the summary of it fits in five words: you have not listened.

The Hebrew behind “rising up early and speaking” is worth slowing down on. It is a picture of someone who gets up before dawn, day after day, hoping this is the morning it lands. Yahweh uses it of Himself twice in this chapter. That is not the language of a God who lost patience quickly.

Then verse 11 does something the book has not done before. It puts a number on the disaster. Seventy years. Not forever - seventy. Chronicles later reads that number as the land finally collecting the Sabbath rests it had been denied, and Daniel is found reading this very verse in exile and beginning to pray because he realized the clock was nearly done. A boundary is a mercy. It means the thing has an end that God Himself set.

And then the cup. Jeremiah is handed it and told to make the nations drink, and the list runs outward in widening rings from Jerusalem - Egypt, Philistia, Edom, Moab, Tyre, Arabia, Elam, Media - and ends with Sheshach, an old cipher in which the letters of Babel are reversed. Even the hand holding the rod drinks last.

But notice where the pouring starts. Verse 29: "I begin to work evil at the city which is called by my name." Not the pagans first, and the covenant people if there is any wrath left over. His own house, first. Peter says the same thing seven centuries later in almost the same words.

Before we read, hold both halves of this chapter together. The God who sets a seventy-year limit on His people's discipline is the same God who hands the cup to every kingdom on earth. Neither the mercy nor the severity is a mood. Both are exact.

Jeremiah 25:1-38 (WEB)

- 1 The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah (the same was the first year of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon),
- 2 which Jeremiah the prophet spoke to all the people of Judah, and to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem:
- 3 From the thirteenth year of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah, even to this day, these twenty-three years, Yahweh's word has come to me, and I have spoken to you, rising up early and speaking; but you have not listened.¹
- 4 Yahweh has sent to you all his servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them (but you have not listened or inclined your ear to hear),
- 5 saying, "Return now everyone from his evil way, and from the evil of your doings, and dwell in the land that Yahweh has given to you and to your fathers, from of old and even forever more."²
- 6 Don't go after other gods to serve them or worship them, and don't provoke me to anger with the work of your hands; then I will do you no harm."
- 7 "Yet you have not listened to me," says Yahweh; "that you may provoke me to anger with the work of your hands to your own hurt."
- 8 Therefore Yahweh of Armies says: "Because you have not heard my words,

¹ Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 7:25](#) • [2 Chronicles 36:15-16](#) - Yahweh rising up early to send prophets, and a people who mocked them until there was no remedy

² Cross-Reference: [Jeremiah 18:11](#) • [Ezekiel 33:11](#) - the same plain call throughout - turn back, for He takes no pleasure in the death of the wicked

9 behold, I will send and take all the families of the north,” says Yahweh, “and I will send to Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will bring them against this land, and against its inhabitants, and against all these nations around. I will utterly destroy them, and make them an astonishment, and a hissing, and perpetual desolations.^{3,4}

10 Moreover I will take from them the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, the sound of the millstones, and the light of the lamp.^{5,6}

11 This whole land will be a desolation, and an astonishment; and these nations will serve the king of Babylon seventy years.⁷

12 “It will happen, when seventy years are accomplished, that I will punish the king of Babylon and that nation,” says Yahweh, “for their iniquity. I will make the land of the Chaldeans desolate forever.

13 I will bring on that land all my words which I have pronounced against it, even all that is written in this book, which Jeremiah has prophesied against all the nations.

14 For many nations and great kings will make bondservants of them, even of them. I will recompense them according to their deeds, and according to the work of their hands.”

15 For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says to me: “Take this cup of the wine of wrath from my hand, and cause all the nations to whom I send you to drink it.^{8,9}

16 They will drink, and reel back and forth, and be insane, because of the sword that I will send among them.”

17 Then took I the cup at Yahweh’s hand, and made all the nations to drink, to whom Yahweh had sent me:

18 Jerusalem, and the cities of Judah, with its kings and its princes, to make them a desolation, an astonishment, a hissing, and a curse, as it is today;

19 Pharaoh king of Egypt, with his servants, his princes, and all his people;

³ **Cross-Reference:** [Isaiah 10:5](#) • [Isaiah 45:1](#) - Assyria as the rod of His anger, and Cyrus called His anointed - empires used without consent

⁴ **Messianic Connection:** [Romans 13:1](#) • [John 19:11](#) - no authority except from God, and none held over Him - as Pilate was told to his face

⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 7:34](#) • [Jeremiah 16:9](#) - the silencing of ordinary joy as the recurring mark of a land under judgment

⁶ **Messianic Connection:** [Revelation 18:22-23](#) • [John 3:29](#) - the same silence falling on Babylon at last, and the Bridegroom’s voice heard again

⁷ **Cross-Reference:** [2 Chronicles 36:21](#) • [Daniel 9:2](#) - the seventy years as the land’s unpaid Sabbaths, and Daniel reading this verse in exile

⁸ **Cross-Reference:** [Psalm 75:8](#) • [Isaiah 51:17](#) - the cup in Yahweh’s hand, foaming and mixed, drained to the dregs

⁹ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 26:39](#) • [John 18:11](#) - the cup He asked might pass from Him, and then took from His Father’s hand

20 and all the mixed people, and all the kings of the land of Uz, all the kings of the Philistines, Ashkelon, Gaza, Ekron, and the remnant of Ashdod;

21 Edom, Moab, and the children of Ammon;

22 and all the kings of Tyre, all the kings of Sidon, and the kings of the isle which is beyond the sea;

23 Dedan, Tema, Buz, and all who have the corners of their beard cut off;

24 and all the kings of Arabia, all the kings of the mixed people who dwell in the wilderness;

25 and all the kings of Zimri, all the kings of Elam, and all the kings of the Medes;

26 and all the kings of the north, far and near, one with another; and all the kingdoms of the world, which are on the surface of the earth. The king of Sheshach will drink after them.

27 "You shall tell them, 'Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says: "Drink, and be drunk, vomit, fall, and rise no more, because of the sword which I will send among you."'

28 It shall be, if they refuse to take the cup at your hand to drink, then you shall tell them, 'Yahweh of Armies says: "You shall surely drink.

29 For, behold, I begin to work evil at the city which is called by my name; and should you be utterly unpunished? You will not be unpunished; for I will call for a sword on all the inhabitants of the earth, says Yahweh of Armies.'"¹⁰

30 "Therefore prophesy against them all these words, and tell them, "'Yahweh will roar from on high, and utter his voice from his holy habitation. He will mightily roar against his fold. He will give a shout, as those who tread grapes, against all the inhabitants of the earth."^{11,12}

31 A noise will come even to the end of the earth; for Yahweh has a controversy with the nations. He will enter into judgment with all flesh. As for the wicked, he will give them to the sword,"' says Yahweh."

32 Yahweh of Armies says, "Behold, evil will go out from nation to nation, and a great storm will be raised up from the uttermost parts of the earth."

33 The slain of Yahweh will be at that day from one end of the earth even to the other end of the earth. They won't be lamented. They won't be gathered or buried. They will be dung on the surface of the ground.

34 Wail, you shepherds, and cry. Wallow in dust, you leader of the flock; for the days of your slaughter and of your dispersions have fully come, and you will fall like fine pottery."¹³

¹⁰ Cross-Reference: [1 Peter 4:17](#) • [Ezekiel 9:6](#) - judgment beginning at the household of God, starting at the sanctuary itself

¹¹ Cross-Reference: [Amos 1:2](#) • [Joel 3:16](#) - Yahweh roaring from Zion and uttering His voice from Jerusalem

¹² Messianic Connection: [Revelation 14:19-20](#) • [Isaiah 63:3](#) - the great winepress of the wrath of God, trodden by One who trod it alone

¹³ Cross-Reference: [Zechariah 11:3](#) • [Ezekiel 34:2-4](#) - the wailing of shepherds whose glory is ruined, who fed themselves and not the flock

35 The shepherds will have no way to flee. The leader of the flock will have no escape.

36 A voice of the cry of the shepherds, and the wailing of the leader of the flock, for Yahweh destroys their pasture.

37 The peaceful folds are brought to silence because of the fierce anger of Yahweh.

38 He has left his covert, as the lion; for their land has become an astonishment because of the fierceness of the oppression, and because of his fierce anger.

CHAPTER 26 - The Temple Sermon on Trial

Key Notes

- This is the same sermon as chapter 7, told from the outside: chapter 7 gives the content, chapter 26 gives the consequences (Jeremiah 26:1-2).
- The commissioning includes a warning that preachers have quoted ever since: “Don’t omit a word.” The temptation to soften was anticipated (Jeremiah 26:2).
- The purpose clause is pure mercy: “It may be they will listen... that I may relent.” The sermon is delivered in hope of not having to be fulfilled (Jeremiah 26:3).
- The threat that detonates the chapter is one word: Shiloh. Yahweh had let His own sanctuary there be destroyed once already, and everyone in the courtyard knew it (Jeremiah 26:6).
- The reaction is immediate and unanimous - priests, prophets, and all the people seize him: “You shall surely die!” The clergy lead the mob (Jeremiah 26:7-9).
- The civil authorities arrive and convene a court in the entry of the New Gate. Jeremiah’s life is spared, in part, by the separation of powers (Jeremiah 26:10-11).
- His defense is not a legal maneuver. He repeats the sermon, renews the offer of repentance, and then says, “as for me, behold, I am in your hand” (Jeremiah 26:12-14).
- The one warning he adds is about them, not him: kill me and you bring innocent blood on yourselves and on this city (Jeremiah 26:15).
- The verdict turns on a precedent from a hundred years earlier: Micah said Zion would be plowed as a field, and Hezekiah repented instead of executing him (Jeremiah 26:16-19).
- Then the chapter tells a second story with the opposite ending. Uriah preached the same message, fled to Egypt in fear, was extradited, and was killed by Jehoiakim (Jeremiah 26:20-23).
- Jeremiah lives because one man stood in the gap - “the hand of Ahikam the son of Shaphan was with Jeremiah.” Providence often has a name and an address (Jeremiah 26:24).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Don't Omit a Word	Jeremiah 26:2 • Deuteronomy 4:2 • Acts 20:27
That I May Relent	Jeremiah 26:3 • Jeremiah 18:7-10 • Jonah 3:10
Remember Shiloh	Jeremiah 26:6 • Jeremiah 7:12 • Psalm 78:60
“This Man Is Worthy of Death”	Jeremiah 26:11 • Jeremiah 38:4 • Amos 7:10-13
Innocent Blood on a City	Jeremiah 26:15 • Deuteronomy 19:10 • Jonah 1:14
The Micah Precedent	Jeremiah 26:18 • Micah 3:12 • Micah 1:1
Hezekiah Entreated Yahweh's Favor	Jeremiah 26:19 • 2 Kings 19:14-19 • 2 Chronicles 32:26
Ahikam Son of Shaphan	Jeremiah 26:24 • 2 Kings 22:12-14 • Jeremiah 39:14

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
A Temple Saying Made a Capital Charge	Jeremiah 26:8-9 • Matthew 26:59-61 • John 2:19-21
"He Is Worthy of Death"	Jeremiah 26:11 • Matthew 26:66 • John 19:7
"I Am in Your Hand"	Jeremiah 26:14 • Isaiah 53:7 • John 19:11
Innocent Blood Called Down	Jeremiah 26:15 • Matthew 27:24-25 • Acts 5:28
Prophets Slain With the Sword	Jeremiah 26:23 • Hebrews 11:37 • Matthew 23:34-35
One Man Standing Between	Jeremiah 26:24 • Hebrews 7:25 • Romans 8:34

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 26 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the trial narrative, the Micah precedent, and the contrasting fate of Uriah
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 26](#) - Shiloh, the temple's conditional standing, and the covenant logic behind the sermon
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 26](#) - exposition of the trial and what it shows about God's use of ordinary courage

Jeremiah 26 - Opening Intro

Chapter 7 gave us the sermon. Chapter 26 gives us what it cost.

And the instruction beforehand is the part that should make anyone who has ever had to say a hard thing pause: "Don't omit a word." Yahweh knows exactly which sentence Jeremiah will be tempted to leave out - the one about Shiloh - and forbids the omission in advance.

Shiloh was the pressure point. It was where the tabernacle stood for centuries, and it was destroyed, and archaeology has turned up the burn layer. Everyone in that courtyard knew the story and had quietly decided it could not happen twice. Jeremiah says the quiet part out loud, and the priests move to kill him inside the hour.

Then watch the trial, because two things save him and neither of them is a miracle. The first is a handful of old men who remember their history: Micah said this same thing about Zion a century ago, and Hezekiah's response was repentance rather than execution. Scripture citing Scripture, in a courtroom, saves a man's life.

The second is Ahikam. He gets one verse and no speech. He was Shaphan's son, from the family that found the scroll in Josiah's day, and his hand was with Jeremiah so the crowd did not get him. His son Gedaliah will protect Jeremiah again after the city falls.

But the chapter refuses to be tidy about it. Uriah preached the same message and was hunted down in Egypt and killed. Same word, same courage, different ending. Faithfulness is not a guarantee of survival, and the book will not pretend otherwise.

Before we read, sit with what Jeremiah actually says when his life is in the balance. Not a defense. Not a retraction. "I am in your hand. Do with me what is good and right in your eyes." And then one more warning - for them.

Jeremiah 26:1-24 (WEB)

1 In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, this word came from Yahweh:

2 "Yahweh says: 'Stand in the court of Yahweh's house, and speak to all the cities of Judah, which come to worship in Yahweh's house, all the words that I command you to speak to them. Don't omit a word.'¹⁴

3 It may be they will listen, and every man turn from his evil way; that I may relent from the evil which I intend to do to them because of the evil of their doings.'¹⁵

4 You shall tell them, "Yahweh says: 'If you will not listen to me, to walk in my law, which I have set before you,

5 to listen to the words of my servants the prophets, whom I send to you, even rising up early and sending them, but you have not listened;

6 then I will make this house like Shiloh, and will make this city a curse to all the nations of the earth.'"¹⁶

7 The priests and the prophets and all the people heard Jeremiah speaking these words in Yahweh's house.

8 When Jeremiah had finished speaking all that Yahweh had commanded him to speak to all the people, the priests and the prophets and all the people seized him, saying, "You shall surely die!"¹⁷

9 Why have you prophesied in Yahweh's name, saying, 'This house will be like Shiloh, and this city will be desolate, without inhabitant?'" All the people were crowded around Jeremiah in Yahweh's house.

¹⁴ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 4:2](#) • [Acts 20:27](#) - nothing added and nothing taken away, and the whole counsel of God declared without shrinking

¹⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 18:7-10](#) • [Jonah 3:10](#) - the declared word held open to repentance - Yahweh relenting when a nation actually turns

¹⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 7:12](#) • [Psalm 78:60](#) - Shiloh, where He first set His name and then forsook the tent He had pitched among men

¹⁷ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 26:59-61](#) • [John 2:19-21](#) - a saying about the temple's destruction produced as the capital charge at another trial

10 When the princes of Judah heard these things, they came up from the king's house to Yahweh's house; and they sat in the entry of the new gate of Yahweh's house.

11 Then the priests and the prophets spoke to the princes and to all the people, saying, "This man is worthy of death; for he has prophesied against this city, as you have heard with your ears."¹⁸

12 Then Jeremiah spoke to all the princes and to all the people, saying, "Yahweh sent me to prophesy against this house and against this city all the words that you have heard.

13 Now therefore amend your ways and your doings, and obey Yahweh your God's voice; then Yahweh will relent from the evil that he has pronounced against you.

14 But as for me, behold, I am in your hand. Do with me what is good and right in your eyes."¹⁹

15 Only know for certain that, if you put me to death, you will bring innocent blood on yourselves, on this city, and on its inhabitants; for in truth Yahweh has sent me to you to speak all these words in your ears."^{20,21}

16 Then the princes and all the people said to the priests and to the prophets: "This man is not worthy of death; for he has spoken to us in the name of Yahweh our God."

17 Then certain of the elders of the land rose up, and spoke to all the assembly of the people, saying,

18 "Micah the Morashtite prophesied in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah; and he spoke to all the people of Judah, saying, 'Yahweh of Armies says: "'Zion will be plowed as a field, and Jerusalem will become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of a forest.'²²

19 Did Hezekiah king of Judah and all Judah put him to death? Didn't he fear Yahweh, and entreat the favor of Yahweh, and Yahweh relented of the disaster which he had pronounced against them? We would commit great evil against our own souls that way!"²³

20 There was also a man who prophesied in Yahweh's name, Uriah the son of Shemaiah of Kiriath Jearim; and he prophesied against this city and against this land according to all the words of Jeremiah.

21 When Jehoiakim the king, with all his mighty men and all the princes heard his words, the king sought to put him to death; but when Uriah heard it, he was afraid, and fled, and went into Egypt.

¹⁸ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 26:66](#) • [John 19:7](#) - the same verdict returned by the same office - he is worthy of death, by our law he ought to die

¹⁹ **Messianic Connection:** [Isaiah 53:7](#) • [John 19:11](#) - the Lamb who opened not His mouth, and who told Pilate where his authority came from

²⁰ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 19:10](#) • [Jonah 1:14](#) - the guilt of innocent blood falling on a land, and sailors who feared to incur it

²¹ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 27:24-25](#) • [Acts 5:28](#) - innocent blood called down by a crowd, and later charged back upon them

²² **Cross-Reference:** [Micah 3:12](#) • [Micah 1:1](#) - the exact prophecy the elders quote, from a prophet of Hezekiah's generation

²³ **Cross-Reference:** [2 Kings 19:14-19](#) • [2 Chronicles 32:26](#) - Hezekiah spreading the letter before Yahweh, and humbling himself so wrath did not come

22 Then Jehoiakim the king sent men into Egypt, Elnathan the son of Achbor, and certain men with him, into Egypt;

23 and they fetched Uriah out of Egypt, and brought him to Jehoiakim the king, who killed him with the sword, and cast his dead body into the graves of the common people.²⁴

24 But the hand of Ahikam the son of Shaphan was with Jeremiah, so that they didn't give him into the hand of the people to put him to death.²⁵

²⁴ **Messianic Connection:** [Hebrews 11:37](#) • [Matthew 23:34-35](#) - those killed with the sword, and the righteous blood charged to the generation that shed it

²⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [2 Kings 22:12-14](#) • [Jeremiah 39:14](#) - Ahikam of Shaphan's family, whose son Gedaliah would shelter Jeremiah again after the fall

CHAPTER 27 - The Yoke on the Prophet's Own Neck

Key Notes

- Jeremiah is told to make a yoke - bonds and bars, the working harness of an ox - and wear it himself. He does not describe submission; he carries it (Jeremiah 27:2).
- The audience is international. Envoys from Edom, Moab, Ammon, Tyre and Sidon are in Jerusalem plotting a coalition, and Jeremiah is to send each of them home with a message (Jeremiah 27:3).
- The theological ground is laid first: "I have made the earth... I give it to whom it seems right to me." Sovereignty over the nations is grounded in creation, not in covenant (Jeremiah 27:5).
- Nebuchadnezzar is again called "my servant," and the grant is explicitly temporary - through his son and his son's son, and then Babylon's own turn comes (Jeremiah 27:6-7).
- The terms are blunt: the nation that puts its neck under the yoke stays on its land and farms it. The nation that refuses is consumed by sword, famine, and pestilence (Jeremiah 27:8-11).
- The list of voices to ignore is long and modern: prophets, diviners, dreamers, soothsayers, sorcerers - a whole industry unified by telling people what they wanted (Jeremiah 27:9-10).
- To Zedekiah personally the message is reduced to five words of ordinary imperative: bring your neck under, and live (Jeremiah 27:12).
- To the priests the issue is the temple vessels. The comfortable prophecy circulating was that the articles taken in 597 would be back shortly, and it was a lie (Jeremiah 27:16).
- Jeremiah proposes a test that costs nothing and exposes everything: if they are really prophets, let them intercede - and see whether the rest of the vessels stay (Jeremiah 27:18).
- The chapter ends where every hard word in this book eventually ends. The vessels go to Babylon - and then, "until the day that I visit them," they come home (Jeremiah 27:22).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Sign-Acts Worn on the Body	Jeremiah 27:2 • Isaiah 20:2-4 • Ezekiel 4:1-3
The Earth Is His to Assign	Jeremiah 27:5 • Psalm 24:1 • Daniel 4:17
Nebuchadnezzar Called His Servant	Jeremiah 27:6 • Jeremiah 25:9 • Isaiah 44:28
Babylon's Own Appointed End	Jeremiah 27:7 • Daniel 5:30-31 • Jeremiah 50:9
Diviners and Dreamers Forbidden	Jeremiah 27:9 • Deuteronomy 18:10-12 • Jeremiah 14:14
Zedekiah Told Plainly to Submit	Jeremiah 27:12 • Jeremiah 38:17-18 • 2 Chronicles 36:12-13
The Vessels Carried to Babylon	Jeremiah 27:16 • 2 Kings 24:13 • Daniel 1:2
The Pillars, the Sea, and the Bases	Jeremiah 27:19 • 1 Kings 7:15-26 • 2 Kings 25:13

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
A Yoke That Is Easy and a Burden Light	Jeremiah 27:2 • Matthew 11:29-30 • Lamentations 3:27
Submission That Inherits the Land	Jeremiah 27:11 • Matthew 5:5 • Philippians 2:8
The Test of a Real Intercessor	Jeremiah 27:18 • Genesis 18:23-32 • Ezekiel 22:30
The Vessels Brought Home	Jeremiah 27:22 • Ezra 1:7-11 • Revelation 21:24-26
A Kingdom Given by the Most High	Jeremiah 27:5-6 • Daniel 7:13-14 • Matthew 28:18
Every Yoke Finally Broken	Jeremiah 27:8 • Isaiah 9:4 • Galatians 5:1

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- [Enduring Word - Jeremiah 27 Commentary \(David Guzik\)](#) - the yoke sign-act, the message to the foreign envoys, and the dispute over the temple vessels
- [United Church of God - Beyond Today Bible Commentary, Jeremiah 27](#) - Yahweh's sovereignty over the nations grounded in creation rather than covenant alone
- [Verse By Verse Ministry International - Jeremiah, Lesson 27](#) - exposition of the intercession test in verse 18 as a mark of genuine prophetic office

Jeremiah 27 - Opening Intro

There is a particular humiliation in this chapter that is easy to read past. Jeremiah does not preach about submission. He builds a yoke - the wooden bars and leather straps you put on an ox - and wears it, in public, in a capital city full of foreign diplomats, for as long as it takes.

And what he tells them is politically indefensible. There is a coalition forming in Jerusalem, five nations plus Judah, and it is exactly the kind of alliance any reasonable government would pursue. Jeremiah walks into it wearing a yoke and says: go home and submit.

Notice how he grounds it. Not "because Judah has sinned" - these are foreign kings, and that argument has no purchase on them. He goes back further, to creation: I made the earth and everything on it by my great power, and I give it to whom it seems right to me. The claim is not covenantal. It is proprietary.

Then he gives Babylon an expiry date in the same breath he gives it an empire. Nebuchadnezzar, his son, his son's son - and then many nations and great kings will make him their bondservant. Three generations, and the historical record lands almost exactly there. Submission is commanded, but it is never presented as permanent.

The sharpest moment is verse 18, and it is worth remembering the next time anyone claims to speak for God. Jeremiah proposes a test: if these men really are prophets, let them pray. Not preach - pray. Let

them stand between Yahweh and the remaining temple vessels and ask that the articles stay. He is measuring prophetic office by intercession rather than by prediction, and the false prophets have nothing to offer, because men who tell people what they want have never learned to stand in the gap.

Before we read, notice how the chapter ends. Not with the yoke. With the vessels coming back - "until the day that I visit them; then I will bring them up, and restore them to this place." Even a chapter about wearing a harness closes with a homecoming.

Jeremiah 27:1-22 (WEB)

1 In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, saying,

2 Yahweh says to me: "Make bonds and bars, and put them on your neck."^{26,27}

3 Then send them to the king of Edom, to the king of Moab, to the king of the children of Ammon, to the king of Tyre, and to the king of Sidon, by the hand of the messengers who come to Jerusalem to Zedekiah king of Judah.

4 Give them a command to their masters, saying, 'Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says, "You shall tell your masters:

5 'I have made the earth, the men, and the animals that are on the surface of the earth by my great power and by my outstretched arm. I give it to whom it seems right to me."²⁸

6 Now I have given all these lands into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant. I have also given the animals of the field to him to serve him."²⁹

7 All the nations will serve him, his son, and his son's son, until the time of his own land comes. Then many nations and great kings will make him their bondservant."³⁰

8 ""It will happen that I will punish the nation and the kingdom which will not serve the same Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and that will not put their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon,' says Yahweh, 'with the sword, with famine, and with pestilence, until I have consumed them by his hand.

²⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [Isaiah 20:2-4](#) • [Ezekiel 4:1-3](#) - prophets whose own bodies became the visual aid - Isaiah barefoot, Ezekiel besieging a brick

²⁷ **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 11:29-30](#) • [Lamentations 3:27](#) - a different yoke offered - easy, light, and good for a man to bear in his youth

²⁸ **Cross-Reference:** [Psalm 24:1](#) • [Daniel 4:17](#) - the earth and its fullness are Yahweh's, and the Most High rules in the kingdom of men

²⁹ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 25:9](#) • [Isaiah 44:28](#) - the second time a foreign emperor is called His servant, as Cyrus is later called His shepherd

³⁰ **Cross-Reference:** [Daniel 5:30-31](#) • [Jeremiah 50:9](#) - Babylon's own night of judgment, and the assembly of nations brought up against her

9 But as for you, don't listen to your prophets, to your diviners, to your dreams, to your soothsayers, or to your sorcerers, who speak to you, saying, "You shall not serve the king of Babylon;"³¹

10 for they prophesy a lie to you, to remove you far from your land, so that I would drive you out, and you would perish.

11 But the nation that brings their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon and serves him, that nation I will let remain in their own land,' says Yahweh; 'and they will till it and dwell in it.'"³²

12 I spoke to Zedekiah king of Judah according to all these words, saying, "Bring your necks under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him and his people, and live."³³

13 Why will you die, you and your people, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, as Yahweh has spoken concerning the nation that will not serve the king of Babylon?

14 Don't listen to the words of the prophets who speak to you, saying, 'You shall not serve the king of Babylon;' for they prophesy a lie to you.

15 For I have not sent them," says Yahweh, "but they prophesy falsely in my name; that I may drive you out, and that you may perish, you, and the prophets who prophesy to you."

16 Also I spoke to the priests and to all this people, saying, Yahweh says, "Don't listen to the words of your prophets who prophesy to you, saying, 'Behold, the vessels of Yahweh's house will now shortly be brought again from Babylon;' for they prophesy a lie to you."³⁴

17 Don't listen to them. Serve the king of Babylon, and live. Why should this city become a desolation?

18 But if they are prophets, and if Yahweh's word is with them, let them now make intercession to Yahweh of Armies, that the vessels which are left in Yahweh's house, in the house of the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem, don't go to Babylon."³⁵

19 For Yahweh of Armies says concerning the pillars, concerning the sea, concerning the bases, and concerning the rest of the vessels that are left in this city,"³⁶

20 which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon didn't take when he carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, from Jerusalem to Babylon, and all the nobles of Judah and Jerusalem;

³¹ **Cross-Reference:** [Deuteronomy 18:10-12](#) • [Jeremiah 14:14](#) - divination and sorcery banned outright, and lying visions from the deceit of their own heart

³² **Messianic Connection:** [Matthew 5:5](#) • [Philippians 2:8](#) - the meek inheriting the earth, and the obedience that went all the way down before it was raised

³³ **Cross-Reference:** [Jeremiah 38:17-18](#) • [2 Chronicles 36:12-13](#) - the same offer made again at the last hour, and a king who would not humble himself

³⁴ **Cross-Reference:** [2 Kings 24:13](#) • [Daniel 1:2](#) - the temple vessels already taken, and set in the treasure house of a foreign god

³⁵ **Cross-Reference:** [Genesis 18:23-32](#) • [Ezekiel 22:30](#) - Abraham bargaining for Sodom, and the man Yahweh sought to stand in the gap and found none

³⁶ **Cross-Reference:** [1 Kings 7:15-26](#) • [2 Kings 25:13](#) - Jachin and Boaz, the bronze sea and its bases - and the day the Chaldeans broke them up

21 yes, Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says concerning the vessels that are left in Yahweh's house, and in the house of the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem:

22 'They will be carried to Babylon, and there they will be, until the day that I visit them,' says Yahweh; 'then I will bring them up, and restore them to this place.'"³⁷

³⁷ **Messianic Connection:** [Ezra 1:7-11](#) • [Revelation 21:24-26](#) - the vessels counted out and carried home, and the glory of the nations brought into the city

Major Themes Across Jeremiah 25-27

- A God who rises up early to send prophets, and twenty-three years of preaching met with silence
- Judgment given a boundary - seventy years, an end date set by the One who set the discipline
- Sovereignty grounded in creation: the earth given to whom He chooses, including to kings who never asked
- The cup of wrath poured out on every nation, beginning at the city that carries His name
- The word delivered whole - "don't omit a word" - and the temptation to soften named in advance
- Shiloh as the standing proof that a sanctuary is not a guarantee
- Faithfulness without a guarantee of survival: Jeremiah spared, Uriah extradited and killed
- Providence with a name and an address - one official whose hand kept a prophet alive
- Submission commanded as the way to live, and never presented as permanent
- Prophetic office measured by intercession rather than prediction, and the homecoming that ends every hard word

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May the God who rose up early to speak to a people who would not listen find us awake, and may we never need twenty-three years to hear what He said the first morning.

May we trust that every discipline He permits has a boundary He set, and may we learn to count the years the way Daniel did - not with despair, but with prayer.

May we hold His sovereignty honestly: that He gives the earth to whom He wills, and that no power over us was ever handed down from anywhere but above.

May He make us people who do not omit the word, and may we be more afraid of softening the truth than of the room's reaction to it.

May we never mistake a building, a heritage, or a history for a guarantee, remembering Shiloh.

May He raise up an Ahikam for every faithful voice under threat, and may He make some of us that person for someone else.

And when His hand puts a yoke on our neck, may we bring the neck under it and live, trusting the One who breaks every yoke in His own appointed time - and who brings the vessels home.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.